

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	\$341.10 ▲ 1.31%	12M Price Target \$360.00	52-Week Range \$243.42 – \$345.34	Market Cap \$4.98T
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AAPL: Near All-Time Highs, Cook Dumping Shares

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL just notched a fresh 52-week high at \$341 — the stock is up 1.3% today and now sits at 96% of its yearly range. Volume today (\$18M shares) is roughly half the recent average, which tells me this isn't a frenzy — it's a quiet, steady grind higher. That usually means institutions are accumulating, not retail chasing.
- The really interesting data point: Tim Cook unloaded ~\$64M worth of stock on October 2nd across four separate sales. When the CEO sells this much right before a push to all-time highs, you pay attention — it doesn't mean the stock crashes, but he's clearly comfortable taking chips off the table here.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm reading: options flow is screaming bullish (put/call ratio of 0.49 means twice as many call bets as put bets, and there's unusual activity in near-the-money calls expiring this month at 6-8x normal open interest). Someone with real money thinks AAPL runs through earnings. BUT — and this is important — Cook's selling plus the stock being at the top of its range means the easy money has been made. The setup now is "melt-up into holiday iPhone sales expectations," and if those numbers disappoint even slightly, you get a quick 8-10% pullback. Translation: don't chase here, but don't short it either.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest policy variable for Apple right now is the ongoing US-China trade posture — Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China and sources a huge chunk of components there, so any new tariff escalation or export control hits margins directly. The second thing to watch is the DOJ antitrust case targeting the App Store's 30% commission ("Apple tax") — if courts force Apple to open up payments and sideloading more aggressively, Services revenue (their highest-margin business) takes a real hit. On the friendlier side, the AI infrastructure build-out has bipartisan support, and Apple's on-device AI story (Apple Intelligence) sidesteps most of the data privacy regulations hammering competitors.

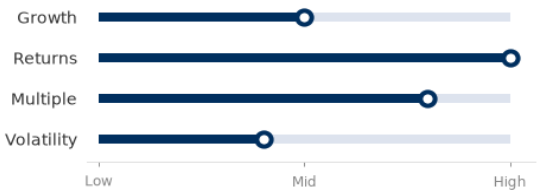
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$341 and ~\$5 trillion market cap, you're paying roughly 43x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$43 for every \$1 Apple is expected to earn next year. That's expensive by Apple's own history (it traded 15-20x for most of the 2010s) and expensive versus the broader market at ~22x. The justification is the Services business (App Store, iCloud, Apple Pay) growing at double digits with 70%+ margins — but at this valuation, the market is already pricing in a lot of that growth being sustained.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$341.10
12M Price Target	\$360.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.5%
Market Cap	\$4.98T
FY2026E Revenue	\$435M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.75
Fwd P/E	43.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$345.00	\$320.00
6 Months	\$380.00	\$355.00	\$300.00
1 Year	\$410.00	\$360.00	\$285.00
2 Years	\$475.00	\$395.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$650.00	\$500.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1000.00	\$700.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+2.97% today, +4.05% week) is on fire — likely oil price action and anticipation of winter demand. Consumer Staples ripping (+2.12%) is a defensive signal — money is positioning for uncertainty.

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't in the top movers today, which is interesting given AAPL's own strength — suggests AAPL is leading tech rather than being carried by it.

ROTATION WATCH: The combo of Energy + Staples + Financials all green while tech is quiet smells like a mild risk-off rotation under the surface. That's often a late-cycle signal — investors hedging bets while keeping mega-cap quality (like AAPL) as a safe hiding spot.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Apple ecosystem thesis but want cheaper exposure, look at the suppliers — AVGO (chips), SWKS (RF), or QCOM. They move with iPhone cycles but trade at much lower multiples.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon): Energy sector leader riding the oil bid — benefits from any Middle East tension or supply discipline.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Enterprise AI monetization is the cleanest story in big tech right now, and government cloud contracts keep flowing.

AAPL CONTEXT: AAPL is actually leading the mega-cap pack today, which is notable because it's doing so WITHOUT a specific catalyst — pure momentum and anticipation of the holiday quarter. That's a sign institutions are positioning for a strong print, but it also means expectations are getting high heading into earnings.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business forever, but I don't love the entry point here with insiders selling and the stock at 96% of its 52-week range.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% as a core holding — this is a "sleep well at night" stock, not a swing-for-the-fences bet. If you already own it, hold. If you don't, wait.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd be a buyer on pullbacks to \$315-325 (roughly the 50-day moving average) — AAPL almost always gives you a dip within 90 days.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months minimum. The catalyst I'm watching is the next earnings print (early November) — specifically China revenue and Services growth.

WHEN TO BAIL: If China revenue drops more than 15% year-over-year, or if the DOJ wins a major App Store ruling, I'm trimming hard.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option at the \$320 strike expiring in 3 months. Think of it like insurance: you pay a small premium (~1-2% of your position) and if the stock crashes, that put pays off and offsets your loss.